

it became obvious that the Apostles were going to have to travel widely, to have an ‘international’ ministry, wouldn’t they bone up on Greek (and even Latin)? If I were in Peter’s shoes I would certainly have done so. In other words, I maintain that Peter and John and James were perfectly competent to write good or correct Greek. To me it is significant that **f**³⁵ habitually sides with the grammatically correct reading, as it does in this case.

πειρασμων 2:9 ⚭ [33%]

Singular or plural? I take the plural to be clearly superior in the context. Again, besides the overt testimony of ⚭, there must be well over twenty independent lines of transmission going back to the 5th century, half of which should go back to the 3rd, besides **f**³⁵. Again I will stick with **f**³⁵. This reading is certainly ancient and in my opinion is most probably original.

Conclusion

Obviously the picture we have seen so far will be true for all other **f**³⁵ minority readings, as we move up to 40%, etc. As in James, 1 Peter and 1 John, **f**³⁵ is clearly early and independent of **K**^x. If it is independent of all other lines of transmission as well, as I believe, then it harks back to the Original—what other reasonable explanation is there?

1 John

As I did with James and 1 & 2 Peter, I take note of what John William Burgon called the *concordia discors*, the prevailing confusion and disagreement, which the early uncials (⚭ABCD—he personally collated each) display between/among themselves.

Concordia discors

Four of those uncials are extant in 1 John (⚭ABC), to which I have added 048, and what Burgon calls their ‘eccentric tendency’ is plainly visible. That eccentricity establishes their independence, which is of special interest in what follows. I proceed to tabulate their performance in the 87 relevant variant sets (excluding 31 with *rell*) included in the critical apparatus of my edition of the Greek Text of 1 John. I do so using **f**³⁵ as the point of reference.

f ³⁵ alone	32	[In these cases the uncials are usually together, but not always.]
f ³⁵ ⚭	10	
f ³⁵ A	7	